Difference between plant and animal cells

S. No	Plant cell	Animal Cell
1	Usually they are larger than animal cells	Usually smaller than plant cells
2	Cell wall present in addition to plasma membrane and consists of middle lamellae, primary and secondary walls	Cell wall absent
3	Plasmodesmata present	Plasmodesmata absent
4	Chloroplast present	Chloroplast absent
5	Vacuole large and permanent	Vacuole small and temporary
6	Tonoplast present around vacuole	Tonoplast absent
7	Centrioles absent except motile cells of lower plants	Centrioles present
8	Nucleus present along the periphery of the cell	Nucleus at the centre of the cell
9	Lysosomes are rare	Lysosomes present
10	Storage material is starch grains	Storage material is a glycogen granules

ions, amino acids, monosaccharides, water, macromolecules like nucleic acids, proteins, lipids and polysaccharides. It appears colourless, jelly like gelatinous, viscous elastic and granular. It appears foamy due to the presence of large number of vacuoles. It responds to the stimuli like heat, electric shock, chemicals and so on.

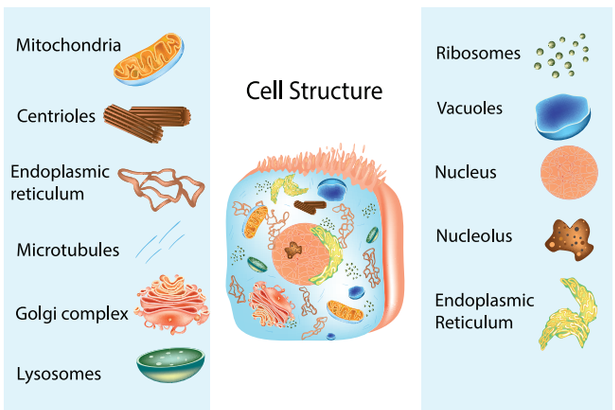


Figure 6.9: Cell structure and components

6.5.3 Cell Wall

Cell wall is the outermost protective cover of the cell. It is present in bacteria, fungi and plants whereas it is absent in animal cell. It was first observed by **Robert Hooke**. It is an actively growing portion. It is made up of different complex material in various organism. In bacteria it is composed of peptidoglycan, in fungi chitin and fungal cellulose, in algae cellulose, galactans and mannans. In plants it is made up of cellulose, hemicellulose, pectin, lignin, cutin, suberin and silica.

In plant, cell wall shows three distinct regions (a) Primary wall (b) Secondary wall (c) Middle lamellae (Figure 6.10).

a. Primary wall

It is the first layer inner to middle lamella, primarily consisting of loose network of cellulose microfibrils in a gel matrix. It is thin, elastic and extensible.In most plants the microfibrils are made up of cellulose oriented differently based on shape and thickness of the wall. The matrix of the primary wall is composed of hemicellulose, pectin, glycoprotein and water. Hemicellulose binds the microfibrils with matrix and glycoproteins control the orientation of microfibrils while pectin serves as filling material of the matrix. Cells such as parenchyma and meristems have only primary wall.

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